- **GENERAL**

  Rig Runner Inc. will ensure that all potential hazards regarding ladders within our facility or job sites are evaluated. This standard practice instruction is intended to address comprehensively the issues of; evaluating and identifying potential deficiencies, evaluating the associated potential hazards, communicating information concerning these hazards, and establishing appropriate procedures, and protective measures for employees.

- **Fixed Stairs**

  Fixed stairs must be provided for access from one structure level to another when operations require regular travel between two levels or the carrying of tools or equipment by hand is normally required. Rise height and tread must be uniform throughout any flight of stairs including any foundation structure used as one or more treads of the stairs. The following also applies to fixed stairs:

  - All stair treads must be reasonably slip resistant and the nosing is to be of a non-slip finish.
  - Stairways must have an angle between 30 and 50 degrees to the horizontal.

  When ascending or descending a stairway, the following safety precautions should be used:

  - Always have at least one hand on the guardrail/handrail at all times.
  - Avoid carry anything up or down stairs that obstructs vision or requires both hands.
  - Avoid running up or down a stairway.

- **Ladders**

  The Company does not use ladders during normal operations. However, ladders may be necessary during some situations. For such occasions, the following applies:

  - Proper Use
    - Only use ladders for their intended purpose. Ladders are used primarily for means to access elevated areas.
    - Ladders are not intended to use as work platforms. Never conduct any work that requires more than one hand while on a ladder, and never extend your belt buckle past the ladders side rail.
    - Ensure that ladders are placed on stable, level surfaces.
    - Avoid carrying items up and down ladders. Utilize a materials line if tools or other materials need to be hoisted.
    - Face ladder when ascending or descending.
    - When ladders are placed by doors, the door should be locked or blocked off. The area around ladders placed in high-traffic areas should be blocked off.
    - Use ladders with the correct load capacity for the task. Do not exceed the manufacturer's load rating for the ladder.
    - Single/extension ladders must be tied off at the top anytime they are standing upright. A second person should secure the ladder during the initial climbing and tying-off.

- Four to One Rule (4:1): The bottom of the ladder is to be one foot away from the wall for every four feet of the structure's height to the point where the ladder rests against it.
- Ladders should extend three (3) feet above the point of contact with the equipment or supporting structure when personnel are to climb onto the equipment or structure.

- **Ladder Involvements**

  If a ladder is involved in any of the following, immediate inspection is necessary:

  1. if ladders tip over, inspect ladder for side rails dents or bends, or excessively dented rungs; check all rung-to-side-rail connections; check hardware connections; check rivets for shear.

  2. If ladders are exposed to oil and grease, equipment should be cleaned of oil, grease, or slippery materials. This can easily be done with a solvent or steam cleaning.

  3. Ladders having defects are to be marked and taken out of service until repaired by either maintenance department or the manufacturer.

- **Ladder Lock-out / Tag-out**

  Ladders will be inspected frequently and those which have developed defects will be withdrawn from service for repair or destruction and tagged or marked as "Dangerous, Do Not Use"